Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam
MGU-UGP (Honours) Regular Examination March 2026
Fourth Semester
DSE - MG4DSEENG201 - Reading Culture: Comics, Cartoons and Fairy Tales
(2024 Admission Onwards)

Duration: 2 hrs **Max. Marks: 70**

Scheme of Valuation

Part A - MCQ
Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. B - Colonial attitudes and environmental impact [K] / [CO1]
2. C – John Favreau [K] / [CO2]
3. C – In a marble pavilion in the middle of a river [K] / [CO3]
4. B – The importance of obedience to parents and social norms [An] / [CO4]
5. A – Terry Gilkyson [K] / [CO2]
6. D – Robert Lowell [K] / [CO3]
7. A – To ask him to make the rangai to sing the river of stories [U] / [CO4]
8. D – Explorers [K] / [CO2]
9. C – It critiques the unrealistic nature of happily-ever after stories [K] / [CO3]
10. C – The power hungry Scar and his actions [K] / [CO4]

(1x10=10)

Part B - SHORT ANSWERS
Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks.

11. *Tintin in Congo* - humans overpower nature – European colonial force against African landscape – Tintin takes part in big game hunting (popular among whites) and slaughters animals for their skin and tusk. *Tintin in Tibet* – power struggle between nature and humans – nature possessing a dominant hand. [An] / [CO1]

12. Mowgli - a man cub adopted into the Seeone wolfpack – raised him according to the Law of the Jungle. Though human by birth, he belongs to the animal world – struggles between jungle life and human society. [An] / [CO2]

13. Miraculous birth of Princess Aubergine i.e. from an aubergine (brinjal) – Beauty as an asset and vulnerability – Queen is madly jealous of Aubergine's beauty – Cruel Mother motif – kills her own sons to destroy Aubergine – Ineffective Father Motif – the Queen traps her (Tests and Trials motif). [U] / [CO3]

14. Both Hamlet and Simba – victims of circumstances – Hamlet's morality v/s revenge – Simba's guilt of his father's death and escape – Claudius and Scar – jealous and commit murder. [U] / [CO4]

15. *Tintin in Congo* – ecological exploitation of the land of the colonized – Tintin appears as a superior European figure – Africa as an exotic land – Reflects colonial ideology (Europeans

as civilizers). *Tintin in Tibet* – vast Himayalan landscape – Tintin is vulnerable and dependent – Nature is a dominant, threatening force that challenges humans. [An] / [CO1]

16. *The Jungle Book* - forms an intertextual web – draws on traditions of Aesop's fables – RKJB (Rudyard Kipling's *Jungle Book*) itself is fragmented – The presence of "In the Rukh," which features an adult Mowgli, demonstrates intratextuality within Rudyard Kipling's own works. The text is also indebted to multiple pre-texts, including colonial ethnographic writings like *Beast and Man in India*, adventure fiction such as "Nada the Lily", and elements of Hindu mythology, especially in its emphasis on law, hierarchy, and order. Thus, *The Jungle Book* functions not merely as a single narrative but as a signifier within a larger intertextual system, influencing and shaping later representations of jungle life and animal societies. In this sense, it becomes a hegemonic text, capable of defining the genre it belongs to.

[An] / [CO2]

17. Cinderella – classic fairy-tale motif of a persecuted heroine. Stepsisters – cruelty, jealousy and arrogance – treated Cinderella as a servant – forced her to do all household chores – mocked at her dirty appearance – excluded her socially – moral ugliness. [An] / [CO3]

18. The relationship between Mufasa and Scar in *The Lion King* is complex, shaped by brotherhood, rivalry, jealousy, and betrayal. It forms the central conflict of the story – Mufasa and Scar are brothers, but Mufasa is the rightful king and Scar is the younger, sidelined sibling – Scar envies Mufasa because he holds power and respect, and his son Simba will inherit the throne. Scar feels inferior and overlooked, which turns into deep resentment – Scar's jealousy leads him to plot Mufasa's death and betray his own brother during the stampede. [U] / [CO4]

19. Small-Scale Water Projects – Small check dams – Local irrigation tanks – Watershed management systems – Decentralized Water Management – Rainwater Harvesting – Improve Irrigation Techniques – Drip irrigation – Sprinkler systems – Proper Rehabilitation Instead of Forced Displacement – Alternative Energy Sources – Solar energy – Wind energy – Small hydro projects. [K] / [CO4]

(5x6=30)

PART Part C - ESSAY

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

20. Superman - a cultural phenomenon (American Cultural narratives) – 9/11 attack – an end of postmodernism in America – Superhero movies and Metanarratives re-emerged – Grand narratives of truth, justice, democracy relapsed – Modernist hero – Superman chooses violence to fight against evils rather than relying on the institutional justice – a response to modernist existential chaos –Superman as a Messianic figure – His existence is mythical and sacred, imbued with values – His moral vision – no ambiguity in right and wrong.

[An] / [CO1]

21. Janguru Bukku Shonen Mowgli – Bildungsroman of Mowgli character. Physical development – weakness to mastery of jungle – depends on the wolf pack for survival. His body becomes attuned to the jungle, almost animal-like – Torn between jungle (freedom, instinct) and society (reason, culture) – Emotional growth through loss, betrayal, experiences – The Boomerang cements his strength and confidence – The real psychological development: Mowgli accepts his position in the man-village and 'outgrows the jungle'.

[A] / [CO2]

22. Princess Anna – passive heroine v/s ideal femininity – silenced subject – Marriage is not a choice, but an inevitable destiny – prince hides his marriage from mother – morality is situational – Jealous and ogre mother-in-law tries to eat grandchildren namely Sun and Pearl – Maternal instinct is inverted to violence – Dangers in family [An] / [CO3]

23. Traditional tale – Little Red Riding Hood is naïve, helpless and a victim of the wolf. In Carter's version, the girl is bold, fearless and self-aware – female innocence to female agency – wolf is a symbol of patriarchy – she challenges male aggression and predatory desire – tames the wolf in the end. [An] / [CO4]

(15x2=30)